Unit 7 Challenges of Nation Building



Learning Objectives

- To outline the emergence and the phase-out of Princely States from pre-independence to post-independence
- To explain the need for the integration of Princely States in order to consolidate administrative and political fragments
- To compare the reasons between the apprehension of the Indian government and the insistence of citizens to reorganise States based on linguistic factors
- To discuss the effectiveness of the changes India underwent after the integration of Princely States and linguistic reorganisation of States
- To review the different Commissions set up by the government and Acts passed by the Parliament towards reorganisation of States
- To interpret the social, economic, political, linguistic, and administrative challenges of nation building
- To illustrate elaborately the various pressing factors that influenced the creation of Tamil Nadu State, thereby establishing a strong foundation for linguistic, ethnic, and political autonomy

7.1 Integration of Princely States

Emergence of Princely States in India

A 'princely state' or a 'native state' is a political unit of a larger administrative province, which either is ruled directly by monarchic lineage or serves as a subsidiary coalition with a more powerful monarchic government. These smaller administrative pockets were based on the political, cultural, lingual, and geographical landscape. In the westerns and central India princely states came into existence with the entry of Rajputs into the Indian sub-continent who migrated from Central Asia around 200 AD(CE). The word 'Rajput' means 'sons of kings'. Hence, princely states were established even before the Mughal and British colonial invasion. There were a number of Non-Rajput princely states too some ruled by Nawabs and Nijams, some ruled by native dynasties like Mysore, Travancore and Pudukottai. All those monarchical states subordinated to the British India were termed as Princely States. However, the word 'princely' was deliberately retained during the British regime, to ascribe subordination of the rulers in the sub-continent to the British Crown.

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